THE START
THE WHY: INTRODUCTIONS

Michael Smith
mike@slideheroes.com

SLIDEHEROES

GOLDEN RULE

WE ARE CREATING OUR PRESENTATION TO ANSWER A QUESTION IN THE MIND OF OUR AUDIENCE

The reason we are creating a presentation, is always to answer a question that is in the mind of our audience.

The Start

ANSWERING QUESTIONS

OUR TOPIC A QUESTION IN THE MIND OF OUR AUDIENCE

- Our database software is inefficient and needs to be replaced, how do we go about selecting and installing an alternative solution?

OUR TOPIC A QUESTION IN THE MIND OF OUR AUDIENCE

- Our database software is inefficient and needs to be replaced, how do we go about selecting and installing an alternative solution?
- We want to enter a new market, what should our strategy be?

OUR TOPIC A QUESTION IN THE MIND OF OUR AUDIENCE

- Our database software is inefficient and needs to be replaced, how do we go about selecting and installing an alternative solution?
- We want to enter a new market, what should our strategy be?
- We need to cut costs, should we pursue Option A or Option B?

OUR TOPIC A QUESTION IN THE MIND OF OUR AUDIENCE

- Our database software is inefficient and needs to be replaced, how do we go about selecting and installing an alternative solution?
- We want to enter a new market, what should our strategy be?
- We need to cut costs, should we pursue Option A or Option B?
- How did we do last year (and what does that mean going forward?)

OUR TOPIC A QUESTION IN THE MIND OF OUR AUDIENCE

- Our database software is inefficient and needs to be replaced, how do we go about selecting and installing an alternative solution?
- We want to enter a new market, what should our strategy be?
- We need to cut costs, should we pursue Option A or Option B?
- How did we do last year (and what does that mean going forward?)
- Do I need to buy your product? Are you qualified to help me?

ANSWERING QUESTIONS NOT DISCUSSING TOPICS

WHAT IS MY PRESENTATION ABOUT?

- Software updates
- Customer relationship management

ANSWERING QUESTIONS NOT DISCUSSING TOPICS

WHAT IS MY PRESENTATION ABOUT?

- Software updates
- Customer relationship management

WHAT IS THE AUDIENCE'S QUESTION?

- Our database software is inefficient and needs to be replaced, how do we go about selecting and installing an alternative solution?

OUR TOPIC A QUESTION IN THE MIND OF OUR AUDIENCE

WHAT IS THE AUDIENCE'S QUESTION?

- Our database software is inefficient and needs to be replaced, how do we go about selecting and installing an alternative solution?

OUR TOPIC A QUESTION IN THE MIND OF OUR AUDIENCE

WHAT IS THE AUDIENCE'S QUESTION?

- Our database software is inefficient and needs to be replaced, how do we go about selecting and installing an alternative solution?

WHAT THE PRESENTATION IS ABOUT

Here is how we can pick and install new database software

OUR TOPIC A QUESTION IN THE MIND OF OUR AUDIENCE

WHAT IS THE AUDIENCE'S QUESTION?

- Our database software is inefficient and needs to be replaced, how do we go about selecting and installing an alternative solution?
- Our database software is old, do I need new database software?

WHAT THE PRESENTATION IS ABOUT

Here is how we can pick and install new database software

OUR TOPIC A QUESTION IN THE MIND OF OUR AUDIENCE

WHAT IS THE AUDIENCE'S QUESTION?	WHAT THE PRESENTATION IS ABOUT
• Our database software is inefficient and needs to be replaced, how do we go about selecting and installing an alternative solution?	Here is how we can pick and install new database software
• Our database software is old, do I need new database software?	Here is why you need to replace your database software

The Start

BUILDING INTRODUCTIONS

INTRODUCTIONS HAVE 3 PARTS

CONTEXT

- The background to the presentation
- Information the audience already knows

CATALYST

- What happened, changed or was realized
- Root cause for us to need to write this presentation

QUESTION

- The question in the mind of the audience

BUILDING THE INTRODUCTION ISOLATES THE QUESTION

To identify the right question (and therefore the answer we will spend our presentation talking about), we first need to work through what our audience already knows about the topic.

INTRODUCTIONS HAVE 3 PARTS

CONTEXT

- The background to the presentation
- Information the audience already knows

CATALYST

- What happened, changed or was realized
- Root cause for us to need to write this presentation

QUESTION

- The question in the mind of the audience

BUILDING THE INTRODUCTION ISOLATES THE QUESTION

To identify the right question (and therefore the answer we will spend our presentation talking about), we first need to work through what our audience already knows about the topic.

INTRODUCTIONS HAVE 3 PARTS

CONTEXT

- The background to the presentation
- Information the audience already knows

CATALYST

- What happened, changed or was realized
- Root cause for us to need to write this presentation

QUESTION

- The question in the mind of the audience

BUILDING THE INTRODUCTION ISOLATES THE QUESTION

To identify the right question (and therefore the answer we will spend our presentation talking about), we first need to work through what our audience already knows about the topic.

INTRODUCTIONS HAVE 3 PARTS

CONTEXT

- The background to the presentation
- Information the audience already knows

CATALYST

- What happened, changed or was realized
- Root cause for us to need to write this presentation

QUESTION

- The question in the mind of the audience

BUILDING THE INTRODUCTION ISOLATES THE QUESTION

To identify the right question (and therefore the answer we will spend our presentation talking about), we first need to work through what our audience already knows about the topic.

INTRODUCTIONS HAVE 3 PARTS

CONTEXT

- The background to the presentation
- Information the audience already knows

CATALYST

- What happened, changed or was realized
- Root cause for us to need to write this presentation

QUESTION

- The question in the mind of the audience

BUILDING THE INTRODUCTION ISOLATES THE QUESTION

To identify the right question (and therefore the answer we will spend our presentation talking about), we first need to work through what our audience already knows about the topic.

OUR TOPIC A QUESTION IN THE MIND OF OUR AUDIENCE

WHAT IS THE AUDIENCE'S QUESTION?

- Our database software is inefficient and needs to be replaced, how do we go about selecting and installing an alternative solution?

CONTEXT

THE CONTEXT

EXAMPLE 1

- We have done some analysis and concluded Russia is an attractive market to enter

THE CONTEXT

EXAMPLE 1

- We have done some analysis and concluded Russia is an attractive market to enter

EXAMPLE 2

- Costs have grown faster than revenue for the last three years. We have completed a benchmarking study that suggests our costs are some of the highest in our industry

THE CONTEXT

EXAMPLE 1

- We have done some analysis and concluded Russia is an attractive market to enter

EXAMPLE 2

- Costs have grown faster than revenue for the last three years. We have completed a benchmarking study that suggests our costs are some of the highest in our industry

BACKGROUND INFORMATION GOES IN THE INTRODUCTION

We place this information into a succinct summary at the beginning of the presentation

GOLDEN RULE

FACTS KNOWN BY THE AUDIENCE GO IN THE INTRODUCTION

If our audience already knows something, the place for this is in the introduction, not in our answer to the question

INTRODUCTIONS HAVE 3 PARTS

CONTEXT

- The background to the presentation
- Information the audience already knows

CATALYST

- What happened, changed or was realized
- Root cause for us to need to write this presentation

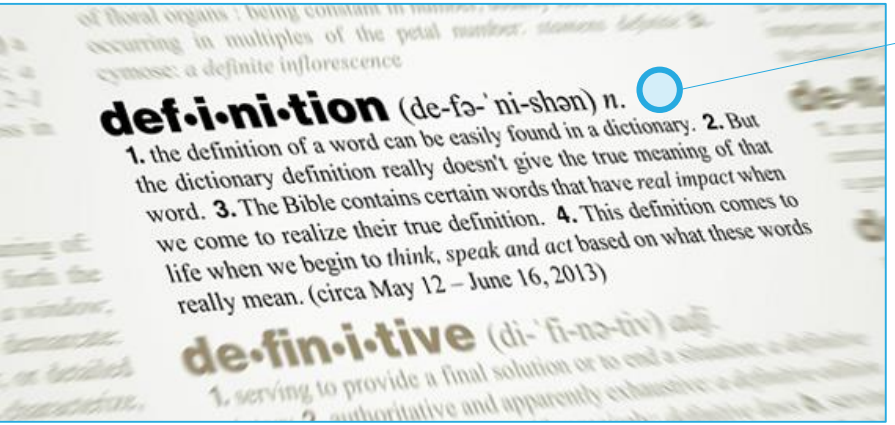
QUESTION

- The question in the mind of the audience

BUILDING THE INTRODUCTION ISOLATES THE QUESTION

To identify the right question (and therefore the answer we will spend our presentation talking about), we first need to work through what our audience already knows about the topic.

THE CATALYST



CATALYST

The complication in the story that has resulted in the problem we are here to answer

What happened, changed or was realized that is causing us to meet today?

RUSSIA MARKET ENTRY STRATEGY

CONTEXT

- In Q1 Global Federated Universal's growth strategy project concluded that Russia presented a fantastic opportunity for growth.

RUSSIA MARKET ENTRY STRATEGY

CONTEXT

- In Q1 Global Federated Universal's growth strategy project concluded that Russia presented a fantastic opportunity for growth.

CATALYST

- Global Federated Universal has asked for help in developing a strategy for entering Russia

RUSSIA MARKET ENTRY STRATEGY

CONTEXT

- In Q1 Global Federated Universal's growth strategy project concluded that Russia presented a fantastic opportunity for growth.

CATALYST

- Global Federated Universal has asked for help in developing a strategy for entering Russia

QUESTION

'How do we enter Russia?'

Question almost doesn't have to be stated, does it?

MOST PRESENTATIONS ANSWER 1 OF 4 QUESTIONS

THE INTRODUCTION

Context → Catalyst → Question → Answer

MOST PRESENTATIONS ANSWER 1 OF 4 QUESTIONS

THE INTRODUCTION

Context → **Catalyst** → **Question** → Answer

- I have a problem
- Someone has suggested a solution
- I have a solution

MOST PRESENTATIONS ANSWER 1 OF 4 QUESTIONS

THE INTRODUCTION

Context → **Catalyst** → **Question** → Answer

- I have a problem
- Someone has suggested a solution
- I have a solution

1. Why did it happen?
2. What should we do?
3. Should we adopt it?
4. How should we implement it?

INTRODUCTION EXAMPLES

	What should we do?	Should we follow our plan?	How should we do what we want to do?
CONTEXT	• We do X today to win in the marketplace	• We have a problem	• We have a problem
CATALYST	• Growth is slowing, competition increasing, X no longer working	• XYZ has recommended doing A	• We know what the solution is, it is hard to implement
QUESTION	'What should we do differently?'	'Is doing A the right action?'	'How do we implement solution?'

INTRODUCTION EXAMPLES

What should we do?

CONTEXT

- Widgets International sells their product through newspaper classified ads.

CATALYST

- No one is reading or buying newspapers anymore

QUESTION

'How should Widgets International sell their widgets?'

INTRODUCTION EXAMPLES

Should we follow our plan?

CONTEXT

- Our analytics SaaS product is a new entrant in a crowded market. We have achieved $10 million in annual recurring revenue and grew 20% last year. Our growth targets for next year are 30% and we are projecting a shortfall

CATALYST

- Our product manager has suggested raising prices

QUESTION

'Should we raise prices?'

INTRODUCTION EXAMPLES

How should we do what we want to do?

CONTEXT

- Silicon Valley Corp is concerned about its inability to get free-trial customers to use its product. 50% of customers who use their free trial become paying customers. Only 5% of trial sign-up take advantage of trial.

CATALYST

- Silicon Valley Corp knows it needs to incentivize customers to try their product

QUESTION

'How should they incentivize customers to try their product?'

LESSON SUMMARY

ANSWER A QUESTION

We create presentations to answer a question that is in the mind of our audience

STRUCTURE INTRO TO PLANT QUESTION

Structure our introductions to 'plant' this question in our audience's mind, so that we can then answer it

INTRODUCTION HAS 3 PARTS

The context section, the catalyst and the question

KNOWN FACTS GO IN INTRO

Facts known by our audience go in the context or background section of our Introduction

CATALYST DRIVES REASON TO MEET

The catalyst is what has happened, changed or was realized that is reason for the presentation

SUBSEQUENT FOCUS ON ANSWERING Q

The rest of the presentation is focused on answering the question